BECS (Book E-Commerce System)

So basically what we're trying to do is get books selling online instead of however you guys are doing it now, just a simple site where people can come in, look through what's available, throw a few books in a cart and check out. Nothing crazy, I just want it to actually work and not be a headache to keep up with. Right now I think it's all kind of manual or scattered and there's no real way for someone to just browse and buy without someone in the middle handling it, so that's the itch we're trying to scratch here.

Anybody coming to the site should be able to just make an account, that's it, no big verification process or anything, and once they're in they can search for books and see title, author, price, add stuff to their cart and go through checkout. Keep the search simple, just matching on the title and it has to be exact, nothing fancy like partial matches or letting people search by author, that's more than we need right now. Some of these people might want to sign up to get notified about promotions and deals, so let's call those folks members, and they're the ones who can use promo codes when they check out. I picture this being pretty bare-bones in terms of who can buy what, like one copy of each book per order is plenty, we don't need people stacking ten copies of the same thing in their cart.

On my side of things, I need a way to manage the inventory, basically a login that lets me add new books, edit prices, see how much stock I've got, that kind of stuff. I also want the system to ping me, like an email or something, whenever a book is running low so I don't get caught without stock, unless I've told it not to bother for that particular book because maybe I'm discontinuing it. And I want to be able to set up these percentage-off promotions every now and then and have it just email all the members automatically when I create one.

One thing I want to be upfront about, we don't need to actually process real credit cards or handle real money movement right now, just collect the card number as part of the checkout flow and spit out a receipt and keep a log of

what was purchased, who bought it, when. The real payment processing piece is something for way later, not part of this. Same with security stuff, I know that sounds bad, but honestly for what we need right now I'm not worried about encryption or people forgetting passwords or whatever, that's not a priority, let's not spend time building password recovery or anything like that for now.

There's only going to be one person managing the store, me basically, so don't worry about building out roles for multiple managers or anything fancy like that, and a manager should never also be a regular customer account, those are two separate hats. It just needs to run somewhere people can get to it through a normal browser, nothing exotic on the technical side, just something stable that people in here can pull up and use without issues.